Lesson plan: Literary devices through poetry

3rd grade English language arts, with accommodations for students with learning disabilities · Katherine Conklin

Grade level: 3rd **Subject:** English language arts

Standard

Alabama ELA Standard 27: Read prose, poetry, and dramas, identifying the literary devices used by the author to convey meaning (personification, imagery, alliteration, onomatopoeia, symbolism, metaphor, and simile).

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Identify and define at least four literary devices (simile, metaphor, alliteration, and onomatopoeia) in a poem
- Analyze how these devices contribute to meaning and imagery
- Create their own sentences or lines of poetry using at least two literary devices

Materials

- Printed and digital versions of “The Sound Collector” by Roger McGough
- Anchor chart with definitions and examples of literary devices
- Graphic organizer for identifying literary devices
- Color-coded highlighters
- Text-to-speech software (for students with dyslexia)
- Word bank and sentence starters (for struggling writers)
- Timer and visual schedule (for students with ADHD)
- Small whiteboards and markers

Introduction (10 minutes): activating prior knowledge

- **Engage:** an interactive “guess the sound” game with real sound effects (thunder, birds chirping, drums), asking what words describe each sound. This leads into onomatopoeia.
- **Introduce:** an anchor chart with definitions and examples of simile, metaphor, alliteration, and onomatopoeia.
- **Turn and talk:** partners create a sentence using one of the devices.

Guided reading and discussion (15 minutes)

- **Read aloud (multisensory):** the teacher reads the poem twice, first with expression, then with text-to-speech so students can follow visually and auditorily.
- **Identify the devices (scaffolded):** chunk the text, highlight each device in its own color, and fill in the graphic organizer below.
- **Think, pair, share:** why do you think the poet used these devices?

Literary device	Example from poem	What it means
Onomatopoeia	“The whistling kettle”	The kettle makes a whistling sound
Alliteration	“Shuffling shoes”	Repeating the ‘sh’ sound for effect
Simile	“Soft as a whisper”	Compares two things using ‘as’
Metaphor	“The wind is a song”	Compares wind to music

Independent practice (15 minutes): creative writing

A choice board for differentiation. Students choose one task:

- Illustrate one stanza of the poem, labeling the literary devices
- Write 3–4 lines of their own poem using at least two devices
- Act out a section of the poem while emphasizing sound words

Students then share with a partner and post their work for a gallery walk.

Assessment and accommodations

Formative assessment: observe participation in turn and talk, highlighting, and discussion; use exit tickets with one literary device and an example.

Dyslexia

- Text-to-speech support for reading
- Guided notes and sentence starters for writing
- Verbal responses allowed instead of written ones

ADHD

- Short activity segments with movement breaks
- Visual timers and schedules
- Fidget tools for students who need sensory input

Closure (5 minutes)

Students hold up fingers for their favorite literary device, then write or dictate one example on an exit ticket.

Reflection and next steps

- The next lesson will focus on symbolism and imagery in prose

- Student work will be compiled into a class poetry book
- Continued focus on multisensory and scaffolded strategies for students with learning disabilities